

2021 Released Tests

Aligned to the Standards

CONTENT BUILDER FOR THE PLC

ELAR English II

Student Expectation/Reporting Category

DISCUSS: How many questions for this Student Expectation were asked over the past years? Which parts were assessed?

IQ Analysis | Investigating the Question

SE #

RC #

Units

SE # Student Expectation

[!][Year][Question #]

Analysis of Assessed Standards

Cluster

Subcluster

Content

Process

Item Type

Stimulus

Data Analysis

Item

State

Local

Error Analysis

☐ Guessing

☐ Careless Error

☐ Stopped Too Early

☐ Mixed Up Concepts

Learning from Mistakes

Instructional Implications

*Correct Answer

Units

COMPLETE: Note the units in which the student expectation is taught.

Analysis of Assessed Standards

DISCUSS and NOTE: Review the cluster, subcluster, content/process standards, and item type assessed for each item.

Stimulus

COMPLETE: Note visual representation used.
DISCUSS and NOTE: How many different stimuli were used to assess this student expectation?

State-Level SE Data and Error Analysis

COMPLETE: Add local data for the item.
DISCUSS and NOTE: What are the most common error patterns?

Learning from Mistakes

DISCUSS and NOTE: What patterns in learning errors emerged across items? What is the best way to respond to those error patterns?

Instructional Implications

DISCUSS and NOTE: How will we adapt instruction to help students improve understanding and application of this student expectation?

In conjunction with the IQ analysis tool, the lead4ward field guides can be a helpful resource for understanding error patterns and instructional implications.

[Learn more](#)

Fiction

E2.2 Vocabulary. The student uses newly acquired vocabulary expressively

E2.4 Comprehension. The student uses metacognitive skills to both develop and deepen comprehension of increasingly complex texts.

E2.5 Response Skills. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student responds to an increasingly challenging variety of sources that are read, heard, or viewed.

E2.6 Literary Elements. The student recognizes and analyzes literary elements within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse literary texts.

E2.7 Genres. The student recognizes and analyzes genre-specific characteristics, structures, and purposes within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse texts.

E2.8 Author's Purpose. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student uses critical inquiry to analyze the authors' choices and how they influence and communicate meaning within a variety of texts. The student analyzes and applies author's craft purposefully in order to develop his or her own products and performances.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Genre	Title	% Correct
2021	7	Fiction	Beartown	66

2021 Passage #7 – Fiction (Questions 46-52)

66% Correct

Beartown is a fictional small town in Sweden.

from Beartown

by Fredrik Backman

1 For more than ten years now the neighbors have grown accustomed to the noises from the Erdahl family's garden: *bang-bang-bang-bang-bang*. Then a brief pause while Kevin collects the pucks. Then *bang-bang-bang-bang-bang*. He was two and a half years old the first time he put a pair of skates on, three when he got his first stick. When he was four he was better than the five-year-olds, and when he was five he was better than the seven-year-olds. During the winter following his seventh birthday he got such a bad case of frostbite that if you stand close enough to him you can still see the tiny white marks on his cheekbones. He had played his first proper game that afternoon, and in the final seconds missed a shot on an open goal. The Beartown youngsters won 12-0, and Kevin scored all the goals, but he was inconsolable. Late that evening his parents discovered that he wasn't in his bed, and by midnight half the town was out searching for him in the forest. It wasn't until dawn that someone realized the boy wasn't among the trees but down on the frozen lake. He had dragged a net and five pucks down there, as well as all the flashlights he could find, and had spent hour after hour firing shots from the same angle from which he had missed the final shot of the match. He sobbed uncontrollably as they carried him home. The white marks never faded. He was seven years old, and everyone already knew that he had the bear inside him. That sort of thing can't be ignored.

2 His parents paid to have a small rink of his own constructed in the garden. He shoveled it himself every morning, and each summer the neighbors would exhume puck-graveyards in their flowerbeds. Remnants of vulcanized rubber will be found in the soil around there for generations to come.

3 Year after year they have heard the boy's body grow—the banging becoming harder and harder, faster and faster. He's seventeen now, and the town hasn't seen a player with anything close to his talent since the team was in the top division, before he was born. He's got the build, the hands, the head, and the heart. But above all he's got the vision: what he sees on the ice seems to happen more slowly than what everyone else sees. You can teach a lot about hockey, but not that. You're either born with that way of seeing or you aren't.

4 "Kevin? He's the real deal," Peter Andersson, general manager of the club, always says, and he ought to know: the last person in Beartown who was as good as this was Peter himself, and he made it all the way to Canada and the NHL,¹ matching up against the best in the world.

5 Kevin knows what it takes; everyone's been telling him ever since he first stood on a pair of skates. It's going to demand nothing less than his all. So every morning, while his classmates are still fast asleep under their warm comforters, he goes running in the forest, and then he stands here, *bang-bang-bang-bang-bang*. Collects the pucks. *Bang-bang-bang-bang-bang*. Collects the pucks. Practices with the junior team every afternoon, and with the A-team every evening, then the gym, then another run in the forest, and one final hour out here under the glare of the floodlights specially erected on the roof of the house.

6 This sport demands only one thing from you. Your all.

7 Kevin has had every sort of offer to move to the big teams, to attend hockey school in a bigger town, but he keeps turning them down. He's a Beartown man, his dad's a Beartown man, and that may not mean a thing anywhere else, but it means something here.

8 So how important can the semifinal of a junior tournament be? Being the best junior team around would remind the rest of the country of this place's existence again. And then the politicians might decide to spend the money to establish a hockey school here instead of over in Hed, so that the most talented kids in this part of the country would want to move to Beartown instead of the big cities. So that an A-team full of homegrown players could make it to the highest division again, attract the biggest sponsors once more, get the council to build a new rink and bigger roads leading to it, maybe even the conference center and shopping mall they've been talking about for years. So that new businesses could appear and create more jobs so that the townspeople might start thinking about renovating their homes instead of selling them. It would only be important to the town's economy. To its pride. To its survival.

9 It's only so important that a seventeen-year-old in a private garden has been standing here since he got frostbite on his cheeks one night ten years ago, firing puck after puck with the weight of an entire community on his shoulders.

10 It means everything. That's all.

From *Beartown*, a novel by Fredrik Backman. Copyright © 2016 by Fredrik Backman. Translation © 2017 by Neil Smith. Reprinted with the permission of Atria Books, a division of Simon & Schuster, Inc. All rights reserved. Third party trademark NHL® was used in these testing materials.

¹NHL stands for National Hockey League.

E2.2(B) analyze context to distinguish among denotative, connotative, and figurative meanings of words	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q47 Passage #7 47 In paragraph 2, what does <i>exhume</i> mean? A Dig up B Blend in C Establish D Conceal <			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q46 Passage #7 46 What do the repeated italicized words “ <i>bang-bang-bang-bang-bang</i> ” in both paragraphs 1 and 5 emphasize? F Kevin’s constant desire to improve G Kevin’s irritation regarding his perceived weakness H Kevin’s need to draw the attention of his neighbors J Kevin’s growing frustration with his teammates 			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q51 Passage #7 51 What does the narrator suggest about Kevin in paragraph 3? A Kevin would have an advantage as a hockey player even if he didn't practice so much. B Many teammates resent Kevin's superior skills. C Kevin has an unhealthy obsession with hockey. D The townspeople's expectations of Kevin are unrealistic. <			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q52 Passage #7 52 Read this quotation from paragraph 7. <i>He’s a Beartown man, his dad’s a Beartown man, and that may not mean a thing anywhere else, but it means something here.</i> Based on the quotation, the reader can infer that Kevin feels — F appreciated G trapped H loyal J embarrassed *Correct Answer (H)	Cluster	Fiction	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F	33	
	G	8	
	H*	57	
	J	2	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

E2.5(C) use text evidence and original commentary to support an interpretive response	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q48 Passage #7 48 Which quotation best suggests that Kevin probably feels increasing pressure from external expectations? F When he was four he was better than the five-year-olds, and when he was five he was better than the seven-year-olds. (paragraph 1) G Year after year they have heard the boy’s body grow—the banging becoming harder and harder, faster and faster. (paragraph 3) H "Kevin? He’s the real deal," Peter Andersson, general manager of the club, always says, and he ought to know. . . . (paragraph 4) J Kevin knows what it takes; everyone’s been telling him ever since he first stood on a pair of skates. (paragraph 5) 			

E2.6(C) analyze isolated scenes and their contribution to the success of the plot as a whole	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q49 Passage #7 49 How are paragraphs 8 through 10 important to the development of the plot? A They show Kevin overcoming an emotional experience of his youth. B They reveal that Kevin wants something different than what the town wants. C They introduce the idea of Kevin leaving the community to play elsewhere. D They explain how Kevin’s abilities may help the entire community.	Cluster	Fiction	
	Subcluster	Across Literary Text	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A	13	
	B	11	
	C	9	
	D*	66	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (D)

E2.6(C) analyze isolated scenes and their contribution to the success of the plot as a whole	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q50 Passage #7 50 Why does the author include the extended flashback in paragraph 1? F To clarify the setting of the story G To give an early example of Kevin’s determination H To introduce characters who are important to the selection J To highlight the conflict that occurs within the town	Cluster	Fiction	
	Subcluster	Across Literary Text	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F	10	
	G*	75	
	H	8	
	J	7	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

*Correct Answer (G)

Informational

E2.2 Vocabulary. The student uses newly acquired vocabulary expressively

E2.4 Comprehension. The student uses metacognitive skills to both develop and deepen comprehension of increasingly complex texts.

E2.5 Response Skills. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student responds to an increasingly challenging variety of sources that are read, heard, or viewed.

E2.7 Genres. The student recognizes and analyzes genre-specific characteristics, structures, and purposes within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse texts.

E2.8 Author's Purpose. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student uses critical inquiry to analyze the authors' choices and how they influence and communicate meaning within a variety of texts. The student analyzes and applies author's craft purposefully in order to develop his or her own products and performances.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Genre	Title	% Correct
2021	5B	Informational	Those Old Piano Blues	64
2021	5A Literary NF 5B Informational	Informational	The Piano Shop on the Left Bank Those Old Piano Blues	67

2021 Passage #5B – Informational (Questions 26-33)

64% Correct

from Those Old Piano Blues

by Neil Wertheimer
AARP Bulletin
October 2017

- 1 For much of the 20th century, most every self-respecting home in America had a piano. It was the home entertainment system long before the era of electronics; families would play and sing together, or listen to their children's recitals. The peak year for piano sales was 1909, when Americans bought 364,500 new models. Sales stayed high until the Depression and World War II years, but once the late '40s arrived, piano sales grew strong and steady again for the next 30 years.
- 2 Then a slow, downward sales arpeggio¹ started. In the late 1970s, "baby boomers began to stop buying new pianos," says Larry Fine, publisher of *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*. "Every year, a sales decline. People are doing other things." In 2016, sales of new acoustic pianos hit a low note of 30,000 units.
- 3 And as more families like ours downsize or move, used pianos have flooded the market. We discovered that no one wanted our Steinway — for any price, including free. We started with music stores that advertised "top dollar" for used pianos. After sending photos and details, we received only declines; one came with a form letter that rang with bitterness. "Pianos often have a substantial amount of emotional value to their owners, so it can be difficult to accept that many pianos do not have meaningful value on the open market," it told us. Reasons include a "tremendous oversupply" of pianos, less interest in them as a home furnishing, and the availability of "inexpensive, realistic" digital pianos.
- 4 The song had gone from major to minor, but we pressed on. None of our friends or relatives wanted it; neither did local churches, schools or charities. Then the song shifted to the saddest of blues. We discovered that the growth area in the business is paying someone to dispose of your old piano. "I've seen a boom in the last five years" of people getting rid of their pianos, says Bob Zahtilla at A Thru Z Piano, a company in Cleveland that sells and maintains, but also removes, pianos. He says he handles roughly five piano removals a month. "We tear them down, recycle the metals."
- 5 "We get lots of calls from schools and institutions looking to get rid of their pianos," adds Mike Ripatti at Beethoven Pianos in New York, another business that sells, services and disposes. They gather old pianos in their warehouse and, once they've accumulated a dozen or so, bring them to the dump. Disposal prices vary based on weight of the instrument and how treacherous its path to the truck is. Typical, though, is about \$300 for an upright.
- 6 But like many a blues song, this piano riff ends with hope. We finally did find a friend who wants our piano, so his young son can learn to play. And while the day of the home piano is passing, "there's no decline in piano lessons," says Natalia Huang, who has piano studios in New York, Los Angeles and Connecticut. "Younger students are brought in to promote a love of music and personal development," Huang says. "Adult students come in for personal growth and stress relief."
- 7 And to be sure, many older pianos have reached their coda.² "Sometimes, they're just ready," Zahtilla notes. A piano's life span is typically 50 years; at that point, it needs rebuilding if it is to be played as it was meant to. So the pruning of a century's worth of neglected home pianos might not be such a bad thing, if we continue to cherish the music.

Republished with permission of AARP Publications, from "Those Old Piano Blues: Once an American home staple, the instruments have fallen out of tune," Neil Wertheimer, 2017; permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Center, Inc.
Third party trademarks *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*®, *Steinway*®, *A Thru Z Piano*® and *Beethoven Pianos*® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

²Coda is an ending part of a piece of music that is separate from the earlier parts.

E2.2(A) use print or digital resources such as glossaries or technical dictionaries to clarify and validate understanding of the precise and appropriate meaning of technical or discipline-based vocabulary		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q30 Passage #5B 30 Read this dictionary entry. boom \ˈbūm\ <i>n</i> 1. a deep hollow sound 2. a rapid increase in activity 3. a long pole for holding a microphone 4. a barrier to obstruct navigation Which definition most closely matches the meaning of <i>boom</i> as it is used in paragraph 4 of the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues”? F Definition 1 G Definition 2 H Definition 3 J Definition 4 * Correct Answer (G)	Cluster	Informational		
	Subcluster			
	Content	Supporting		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	F	9		
	G*	83		
	H	5		
	J	3		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

E2.2(B) analyze context to distinguish among denotative, connotative, and figurative meanings of words		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q32 Passage #5B 32 Which word from the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” means “an approximate amount”? F <i>peak</i> (paragraph 1) G <i>substantial</i> (paragraph 3) H <i>roughly</i> (paragraph 4) J <i>treacherous</i> (paragraph 5) 				

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q27 Passage #5B 27 Read this quotation from paragraph 2 of the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues.” <i>Then a slow, downward sales arpeggio started.</i> What does the author’s use of musical terminology convey in the quotation? A How the popularity of the piano has shifted like notes in a song B How piano dealers use musical language when they speak C How piano tones affect the price of the instruments D How piano music will persist despite its decrease in popularity 			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q28 Passage #5B 28 Which quotation best shows that the author of the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” is relieved someone wants his old piano? F The song had gone from major to minor, but we pressed on. (paragraph 4) G Then the song shifted to the saddest of blues. (paragraph 4) H But like many a blues song, this piano riff ends with hope. (paragraph 6) J And to be sure, many older pianos have reached their coda. (paragraph 7) <			

E2.5(D) paraphrase and summarize texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q33 Passage #5B 33 Which is the best summary of the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues”? A Many families in America once owned acoustic pianos, but there are now fewer families who want them. In fact, if you have an old piano, it can be very hard to sell it or find someone who wants it. That’s why there are companies now offering to pick up old pianos. It is sad these instruments were once prized but have little value today, unless someone is willing to restore them to their original working condition. B Although acoustic pianos were once a popular item in American life, many are now being disposed of or recycled for parts. Changes in American entertainment, as well as the space and upkeep required to own an acoustic piano, have led people to pursue other interests or purchase less expensive digital pianos. However, the number of Americans learning to play the piano has not changed, which shows that the instrument is still appreciated. C Many families in America still own pianos but many of them are now digital pianos. People who own old acoustic pianos still feel sentimental about them and believe they are worth a lot of money. However, the people who make money from pianos are the ones that know how to remove or recycle them. D Today, Americans are learning to play piano as adults, and they often go to piano studios in cities like Los Angeles and New York. Piano playing was popular in the 20th century and still is. Pianos used to be an important part of family entertainment, but other instruments have taken their place. Today, old acoustic pianos are stored in warehouses because they take up too much room in houses. *Correct Answer (B)	Cluster	Informational	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A	34	
	B*	52	
	C	8	
	D	6	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts		
	☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

E2.7(D) (ii) [analyze characteristics and structural elements of informational texts such as] the relationship between organizational design and thesis	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q26 Passage #5B 26 In the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues,” how does the author mainly organize his ideas? F He lists the benefits of owning a piano by referencing a magazine article about musical instruments. G He supports people learning to play the piano with stories from students who enjoy the instrument. H He argues against getting rid of old pianos by explaining how important they once were. J He discusses trends in piano ownership by describing his experience trying to get rid of an old piano. 			

E2.8(A) analyze the author's purpose, audience, and message within a text	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q29 Passage #5B 29 What is the purpose of the information in the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues”? A To explain why traditional pianos have greatly declined in value B To describe the differences between old pianos and new ones C To prove that pianos made in the last century are irreplaceable D To inform people about new American trends with musical instruments	Cluster	Informational	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A*	55	
	B	12	
	C	19	
	D	14	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (A)

E2.8(A) analyze the author's purpose, audience, and message within a text	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q31 Passage #5B 31 In the excerpt from the article "Those Old Piano Blues," what is the primary purpose of paragraph 7? A To explain why letting go of pianos is acceptable at times B To state the reasons why pianos are still important C To detail the life cycle of pianos D To describe pianos in a historical context	Cluster	Informational	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A*	56	
	B	10	
	C	25	
	D	9	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (A)

2021 Passage #5A – Fiction (Questions 19-25)

69% Correct

Thad is considering buying an old Stingl baby grand piano from Luc, the piano shop owner. Thad is playing this piano for the first time.

from
The Piano Shop on the Left Bank

by Thad Carhart

1 I sat on the bench and smiled at Luc. I was nervous, almost spellbound; suddenly this great impractical hulk was the gateway to a territory from which I had been absent for too long. Something said "Yes!" before I even touched the keyboard. I trusted Luc but I realized, too, that I *wanted* to love this piano, I *wanted* to invite music back into my life. I tried a few scales, then some harmonic progressions, and finally, with more certainty, some arpeggios.¹ A thrill that I had not expected ran through me as the notes resounded. The Stingl had a good, clean action, but it took some work to move the keys. None of the vaunted silkiness of the Steinway or the velvet touch of other famous makes; no, this was a profoundly physical undertaking, almost athletic in its requirements. And yet the tone it produced was very sweet and full, a strange and wonderful combination of the robust and the delicate.

2 "It's a nice one, no?" Luc was beaming at my very apparent pleasure.

3 "It's a nice one, yes! It takes some work, but what a beautiful sound."

4 "You're a big guy, you can play a piano like this properly. Not everyone could." I wasn't sure if this was flattery or a dispassionate estimation of my capabilities. A bit of both, no doubt.

5 This was not just any old piano, Luc assured me. It had been made in Vienna in the thirties at a time when Vienna still had a craftsman's tradition worthy of the name (only Bösendorfer remains today), and its clear tone and solid feel suggested a solid pedigree. Never mind its pluck, this had all the marks of a rare find, a fine piano disguised as something simple and dependable. I could imagine it surviving the assaults of my young children, to say nothing of my own.

6 I laughed inwardly at all these musings; the combination of my vanity and artistic longings, together with the ungainly beauty of the piano itself, struck me as funny and vaguely absurd. I imagined myself flawlessly playing Chopin's Heroic Polonaise in A-flat at the keyboard of this unassuming instrument, an impossibility that nonetheless appealed to my sense of fantasy. One of the most difficult compositions for the piano, it would never be within my grasp, but the daydream itself was strangely satisfying. What would a visitor from another

century think of this notion of personal fulfillment that sought a pedigree in the past? My expression must have reflected the deep sense of irony I was feeling because Luc asked me why I was looking puzzled.

7 "It's just occurred to me how much of ourselves we project onto a piano when we consider what we're going to buy."

8 "Ah, but of course, that's the beauty of a piano. It's not just another instrument like a flute or a violin that you put away in the closet. You live with it and it with you. It's big and impossible to ignore, like a member of the family. It's got to be the right one!"

9 "And if one were interested, how much would this piano cost?"

10 "Fifteen thousand francs," was his unhurried response. "Of course, that includes delivery and tuning."

11 I made noises about having to measure my apartment to be sure, but I think that we both knew I was going to buy it. Actually, I think he knew well before I and it puzzles me still to consider how he made that assessment after our brief encounters. But then, we reveal far more of ourselves than we suspect when we enter the bedizened world of our passions and our longings.

12 I returned two days later, having measured my apartment carefully.

13 My wife, Simo, was surprised to hear that all my practical arguments in favor of an upright—the cost, the size, the children—had vanished virtually overnight. "What happened to the idea of a small piano?"

14 I listed all my points in favor of a grand, babbling with enthusiasm as I recited the litany.

15 She listened silently, gave me a long look that mixed skepticism and understanding, then responded to my fervor with the practical point: "Well, we'd better figure out where your new baby is going to live."

16 Together we found a corner between the window and the bookcase that formed an acute angle where the Stingl could be wedged in our apartment's main room. We adjusted our budget for the price Luc quoted. It was a lot of money, particularly since I was just setting out on a new career path as a freelance writer, but my wife encouraged me to indulge my newfound sense of freedom: "Think of it as an investment in personal expression."

17 This time at the atelier² I did bring sheet music, and Luc nodded approvingly when he saw me set it on the music stand. I've never been comfortable playing in front of others, but somehow this was different; his presence seemed encouraging as we listened together to the particular voice of this instrument among so many other pianos. I played for perhaps ten minutes, pieces I knew reasonably well and could listen to while I sight-read: some Beethoven bagatelles, a few of Schumann's pieces for children, an early Mozart fantasy. I was not disappointed. The Stingl's resonance filled the room with

²An atelier is a workshop or studio of an artist.

tones at once clear and robust, and a sharp sense of pride welled up at the prospect of owning this distinctive piano, of seeing and playing it daily, of living with it. Good God, I thought, this is a kind of love; and, as in love, my senses amplified and enhanced the love object, all with an insouciance and willing enthusiasm.

18 I finished playing and turned to Luc with what must have been a delighted look on my face.

19 "I would say that you have found your piano." His eyes sparkled, the successful matchmaker rejoicing in his skill.

20 "And I would say that you were right."

Excerpt(s) from *The Piano Shop on the Left Bank: Discovering a Forgotten Passion in a Paris Atelier* by T. E. Carhart, copyright © 2000 by T. E. Carhart. Used by permission of Random House, an imprint and division of Penguin Random House LLC. All rights reserved.

Third party trademarks Stingl® and Steinway® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

from Those Old Piano Blues

by Neil Wertheimer
AARP Bulletin
October 2017

- 1 For much of the 20th century, most every self-respecting home in America had a piano. It was the home entertainment system long before the era of electronics; families would play and sing together, or listen to their children's recitals. The peak year for piano sales was 1909, when Americans bought 364,500 new models. Sales stayed high until the Depression and World War II years, but once the late '40s arrived, piano sales grew strong and steady again for the next 30 years.
- 2 Then a slow, downward sales arpeggio¹ started. In the late 1970s, "baby boomers began to stop buying new pianos," says Larry Fine, publisher of *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*. "Every year, a sales decline. People are doing other things." In 2016, sales of new acoustic pianos hit a low note of 30,000 units.
- 3 And as more families like ours downsize or move, used pianos have flooded the market. We discovered that no one wanted our Steinway — for any price, including free. We started with music stores that advertised "top dollar" for used pianos. After sending photos and details, we received only declines; one came with a form letter that rang with bitterness. "Pianos often have a substantial amount of emotional value to their owners, so it can be difficult to accept that many pianos do not have meaningful value on the open market," it told us. Reasons include a "tremendous oversupply" of pianos, less interest in them as a home furnishing, and the availability of "inexpensive, realistic" digital pianos.
- 4 The song had gone from major to minor, but we pressed on. None of our friends or relatives wanted it; neither did local churches, schools or charities. Then the song shifted to the saddest of blues. We discovered that the growth area in the business is paying someone to dispose of your old piano. "I've seen a boom in the last five years" of people getting rid of their pianos, says Bob Zahtilla at A Thru Z Piano, a company in Cleveland that sells and maintains, but also removes, pianos. He says he handles roughly five piano removals a month. "We tear them down, recycle the metals."
- 5 "We get lots of calls from schools and institutions looking to get rid of their pianos," adds Mike Ripatti at Beethoven Pianos in New York, another business that sells, services and disposes. They gather old pianos in their warehouse and, once they've accumulated a dozen or so, bring them to the dump. Disposal prices vary based on weight of the instrument and how treacherous its path to the truck is. Typical, though, is about \$300 for an upright.
- 6 But like many a blues song, this piano riff ends with hope. We finally did find a friend who wants our piano, so his young son can learn to play. And while the day of the home piano is passing, "there's no decline in piano lessons," says Natalia Huang, who has piano studios in New York, Los Angeles and Connecticut. "Younger students are brought in to promote a love of music and personal development," Huang says. "Adult students come in for personal growth and stress relief."
- 7 And to be sure, many older pianos have reached their coda.² "Sometimes, they're just ready," Zahtilla notes. A piano's life span is typically 50 years; at that point, it needs rebuilding if it is to be played as it was meant to. So the pruning of a century's worth of neglected home pianos might not be such a bad thing, if we continue to cherish the music.

Republished with permission of AARP Publications, from "Those Old Piano Blues: Once an American home staple, the instruments have fallen out of tune," Neil Wertheimer, 2017; permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Center, Inc.
Third party trademarks *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*®, *Steinway*®, *A Thru Z Piano*® and *Beethoven Pianos*® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

²Coda is an ending part of a piece of music that is separate from the earlier parts.

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q34 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 34 In the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> and the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues,” with which statement would both authors most likely agree? F Old pianos offer a great deal of emotional value to their owners. G Old pianos are constructed from better materials than new pianos. H People can learn a lot about the history of pianos from musicians. J People should learn to play on an acoustic piano before moving to a digital one.	Cluster	Informational	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F*	77	
	G	8	
	H	11	
	J	5	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (F)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q35 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 35 While the narrator of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> finds an old Stingl valuable enough for him to spend a lot of money on it, the author of the excerpt from the article "Those Old Piano Blues" — A expects to sell an old Steinway for a high price B insists on donating his old piano to a school C gives an old Steinway to someone who wants it D thinks old pianos should be destroyed	Cluster	Informational	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A	17	
	B	11	
	C*	67	
	D	6	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (C)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q36 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 36 What is one notable difference between the two excerpts? F The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> explains why someone wants to play piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” explains why piano lessons are less popular. G The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> describes evaluating and buying an old piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” describes an abundance of unwanted old pianos. H The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> emphasizes the craftsmanship of a new acoustic piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” emphasizes today’s preference for digital pianos. J The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> shows how rare it is for someone to appreciate an old piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” shows how people overvalue all musical instruments. 			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q37 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 37 What feeling is conveyed by both the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> and the excerpt from the article "Those Old Piano Blues"? A Amusement B Ambition C Attachment D Awe <			

Literary Nonfiction

E2.2 Vocabulary. The student uses newly acquired vocabulary expressively

E2.4 Comprehension. The student uses metacognitive skills to both develop and deepen comprehension of increasingly complex texts.

E2.5 Response Skills. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student responds to an increasingly challenging variety of sources that are read, heard, or viewed.

E2.6 Literary Elements. The student recognizes and analyzes literary elements within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse literary texts.

E2.7 Genres. The student recognizes and analyzes genre-specific characteristics, structures, and purposes within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse texts.

E2.8 Author's Purpose. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student uses critical inquiry to analyze the authors' choices and how they influence and communicate meaning within a variety of texts. The student analyzes and applies author's craft purposefully in order to develop his or her own products and performances.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Genre	Title	% Correct
2021	5A	Literary Nonfiction	The Piano Shop on the Left Bank	69
2021	5A Literary NF 5B Informational	Literary Nonfiction	The Piano Shop on the Left Bank Those Old Piano Blues	67

2021 Passage #5A – Literary Nonfiction (Questions 19-25)

69% Correct

Thad is considering buying an old Stingl baby grand piano from Luc, the piano shop owner. Thad is playing this piano for the first time.

from The Piano Shop on the Left Bank

by Thad Carhart

1 I sat on the bench and smiled at Luc. I was nervous, almost spellbound; suddenly this great impractical hulk was the gateway to a territory from which I had been absent for too long. Something said "Yes!" before I even touched the keyboard. I trusted Luc but I realized, too, that I *wanted* to love this piano, I *wanted* to invite music back into my life. I tried a few scales, then some harmonic progressions, and finally, with more certainty, some arpeggios.¹ A thrill that I had not expected ran through me as the notes resounded. The Stingl had a good, clean action, but it took some work to move the keys. None of the vaunted silkiness of the Steinway or the velvet touch of other famous makes; no, this was a profoundly physical undertaking, almost athletic in its requirements. And yet the tone it produced was very sweet and full, a strange and wonderful combination of the robust and the delicate.

2 "It's a nice one, no?" Luc was beaming at my very apparent pleasure.

3 "It's a nice one, yes! It takes some work, but what a beautiful sound."

4 "You're a big guy, you can play a piano like this properly. Not everyone could." I wasn't sure if this was flattery or a dispassionate estimation of my capabilities. A bit of both, no doubt.

5 This was not just any old piano, Luc assured me. It had been made in Vienna in the thirties at a time when Vienna still had a craftsman's tradition worthy of the name (only Bösendorfer remains today), and its clear tone and solid feel suggested a solid pedigree. Never mind its pluck, this had all the marks of a rare find, a fine piano disguised as something simple and dependable. I could imagine it surviving the assaults of my young children, to say nothing of my own.

6 I laughed inwardly at all these musings; the combination of my vanity and artistic longings, together with the ungainly beauty of the piano itself, struck me as funny and vaguely absurd. I imagined myself flawlessly playing Chopin's Heroic Polonaise in A-flat at the keyboard of this unassuming instrument, an impossibility that nonetheless appealed to my sense of fantasy. One of the most difficult compositions for the piano, it would never be within my grasp, but the daydream itself was strangely satisfying. What would a visitor from another

century think of this notion of personal fulfillment that sought a pedigree in the past? My expression must have reflected the deep sense of irony I was feeling because Luc asked me why I was looking puzzled.

7 "It's just occurred to me how much of ourselves we project onto a piano when we consider what we're going to buy."

8 "Ah, but of course, that's the beauty of a piano. It's not just another instrument like a flute or a violin that you put away in the closet. You live with it and it with you. It's big and impossible to ignore, like a member of the family. It's got to be the right one!"

9 "And if one were interested, how much would this piano cost?"

10 "Fifteen thousand francs," was his unhurried response. "Of course, that includes delivery and tuning."

11 I made noises about having to measure my apartment to be sure, but I think that we both knew I was going to buy it. Actually, I think he knew well before I and it puzzles me still to consider how he made that assessment after our brief encounters. But then, we reveal far more of ourselves than we suspect when we enter the bedizened world of our passions and our longings.

12 I returned two days later, having measured my apartment carefully.

13 My wife, Simo, was surprised to hear that all my practical arguments in favor of an upright—the cost, the size, the children—had vanished virtually overnight. "What happened to the idea of a small piano?"

14 I listed all my points in favor of a grand, babbling with enthusiasm as I recited the litany.

15 She listened silently, gave me a long look that mixed skepticism and understanding, then responded to my fervor with the practical point: "Well, we'd better figure out where your new baby is going to live."

16 Together we found a corner between the window and the bookcase that formed an acute angle where the Stingl could be wedged in our apartment's main room. We adjusted our budget for the price Luc quoted. It was a lot of money, particularly since I was just setting out on a new career path as a freelance writer, but my wife encouraged me to indulge my newfound sense of freedom: "Think of it as an investment in personal expression."

17 This time at the atelier² I did bring sheet music, and Luc nodded approvingly when he saw me set it on the music stand. I've never been comfortable playing in front of others, but somehow this was different; his presence seemed encouraging as we listened together to the particular voice of this instrument among so many other pianos. I played for perhaps ten minutes, pieces I knew reasonably well and could listen to while I sight-read: some Beethoven bagatelles, a few of Schumann's pieces for children, an early Mozart fantasy. I was not disappointed. The Stingl's resonance filled the room with

²An atelier is a workshop or studio of an artist.

tones at once clear and robust, and a sharp sense of pride welled up at the prospect of owning this distinctive piano, of seeing and playing it daily, of living with it. Good God, I thought, this is a kind of love; and, as in love, my senses amplified and enhanced the love object, all with an insouciance and willing enthusiasm.

18 I finished playing and turned to Luc with what must have been a delighted look on my face.

19 "I would say that you have found your piano." His eyes sparkled, the successful matchmaker rejoicing in his skill.

20 "And I would say that you were right."

Excerpt(s) from *The Piano Shop on the Left Bank: Discovering a Forgotten Passion in a Paris Atelier* by T. E. Carhart, copyright © 2000 by T. E. Carhart. Used by permission of Random House, an imprint and division of Penguin Random House LLC. All rights reserved.

Third party trademarks Stingl® and Steinway® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q19 Passage #5A 19 Read this quotation from paragraph 17 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i>. I thought, this is a kind of love; and, as in love, my senses amplified and enhanced the love object, all with an insouciance and willing enthusiasm. Why does the narrator use a metaphor to describe his response to playing the piano? A To explain how he is able to remember a piece of music B To show how sharing music increases enjoyment C To suggest that owning a piano can spark enthusiasm D To reveal the depth of his feelings towards the piano	Cluster	Literary Nonfiction		
	Subcluster	Across Genres		
	Content	Readiness		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A	5		
	B	11		
	C	8		
	D*	76		
	Error Analysis			
☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early				
Learning from Mistakes				
Instructional Implications				

*Correct Answer (D)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q20 Passage #5A 20 In paragraph 8 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i>, Luc suggests that the narrator — F trust his ability to make decisions G reflect on the commitment of buying a piano H be willing to consider other pianos J think about playing different instruments *Correct Answer (G)	Cluster	Literary Nonfiction	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F	18	
	G*	72	
	H	6	
	J	3	
	Error Analysis		
☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts			
☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q21 Passage #5A 21 In paragraph 1 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> , which idea is introduced? A The power of intuition B An unachieved goal C Impractical choices D The wisdom of experience	Cluster	Literary Nonfiction	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A*	45	
	B	13	
	C	11	
	D	31	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (A)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q22 Passage #5A 22 Read this quotation from paragraph 16 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> . "Think of it as an investment in personal expression." What can the reader infer about the narrator's wife based on her words? F The wife believes it is more important to invest in the arts than in other things. G The wife does not believe people should deny themselves things that they want. H The wife views the piano as an attractive addition to their living room. J The wife sees music as a necessary outlet for her husband's creativity. 			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q23 Passage #5A 23 In paragraph 17 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> , how does the narrator feel about playing the Stingl piano in the piano shop? A He needs Luc to help him build confidence in his musical ability. B He hopes Luc will believe that he is worthy of the Stingl. C He feels oddly comfortable playing in front of Luc. D He enjoys showing Luc that he can play different types of music. 			

E2.8(F) analyze how the author's diction and syntax contribute to the mood, voice, and tone of a text	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q24 Passage #5A 24 In paragraph 1 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> , why does the narrator describe the piano as “a strange and wonderful combination of the robust and the delicate”? F To explain why he feels this particular piano is special G To reveal that he needs a piano that is not too fragile or ornate H To state why he is physically able to play this particular piano J To suggest that he prefers a piano that won’t require much upkeep <			

E2.8(F) analyze how the author's diction and syntax contribute to the mood, voice, and tone of a text		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q25 Passage #5A 25 Read this quotation from paragraph 1 of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i>. <i>I was nervous, almost spellbound; suddenly this great impractical hulk was the gateway to a territory from which I had been absent for too long. Something said "Yes!" before I even touched the keyboard.</i> What is the narrator's purpose for including this description? A To explain where he is shopping for a piano B To highlight his doubts about wanting a piano C To show how he exaggerates when describing events D To reveal the strength of his desire to play the piano again		Cluster	Literary Nonfiction	
		Subcluster	Across Genres	
		Content	Readiness	
		Process		
		Stimulus		
		Data Analysis		
		Item	State	Local
		A	3	
		B	7	
C	10			
D*	81			
Error Analysis				
☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts				
☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early				
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

* Correct Answer (D)

2021 Passage #5A – Literary Nonfiction (Questions 19-25)

69% Correct

Thad is considering buying an old Stingl baby grand piano from Luc, the piano shop owner. Thad is playing this piano for the first time.

from
The Piano Shop on the Left Bank

by Thad Carhart

1 I sat on the bench and smiled at Luc. I was nervous, almost spellbound; suddenly this great impractical hulk was the gateway to a territory from which I had been absent for too long. Something said "Yes!" before I even touched the keyboard. I trusted Luc but I realized, too, that I *wanted* to love this piano, I *wanted* to invite music back into my life. I tried a few scales, then some harmonic progressions, and finally, with more certainty, some arpeggios.¹ A thrill that I had not expected ran through me as the notes resounded. The Stingl had a good, clean action, but it took some work to move the keys. None of the vaulted silkiness of the Steinway or the velvet touch of other famous makes; no, this was a profoundly physical undertaking, almost athletic in its requirements. And yet the tone it produced was very sweet and full, a strange and wonderful combination of the robust and the delicate.

2 "It's a nice one, no?" Luc was beaming at my very apparent pleasure.

3 "It's a nice one, yes! It takes some work, but what a beautiful sound."

4 "You're a big guy, you can play a piano like this properly. Not everyone could." I wasn't sure if this was flattery or a dispassionate estimation of my capabilities. A bit of both, no doubt.

5 This was not just any old piano, Luc assured me. It had been made in Vienna in the thirties at a time when Vienna still had a craftsman's tradition worthy of the name (only Bösendorfer remains today), and its clear tone and solid feel suggested a solid pedigree. Never mind its pluck, this had all the marks of a rare find, a fine piano disguised as something simple and dependable. I could imagine it surviving the assaults of my young children, to say nothing of my own.

6 I laughed inwardly at all these musings; the combination of my vanity and artistic longings, together with the ungainly beauty of the piano itself, struck me as funny and vaguely absurd. I imagined myself flawlessly playing Chopin's Heroic Polonaise in A-flat at the keyboard of this unassuming instrument, an impossibility that nonetheless appealed to my sense of fantasy. One of the most difficult compositions for the piano, it would never be within my grasp, but the daydream itself was strangely satisfying. What would a visitor from another

century think of this notion of personal fulfillment that sought a pedigree in the past? My expression must have reflected the deep sense of irony I was feeling because Luc asked me why I was looking puzzled.

7 "It's just occurred to me how much of ourselves we project onto a piano when we consider what we're going to buy."

8 "Ah, but of course, that's the beauty of a piano. It's not just another instrument like a flute or a violin that you put away in the closet. You live with it and it with you. It's big and impossible to ignore, like a member of the family. It's got to be the right one!"

9 "And if one were interested, how much would this piano cost?"

10 "Fifteen thousand francs," was his unhurried response. "Of course, that includes delivery and tuning."

11 I made noises about having to measure my apartment to be sure, but I think that we both knew I was going to buy it. Actually, I think he knew well before I and it puzzles me still to consider how he made that assessment after our brief encounters. But then, we reveal far more of ourselves than we suspect when we enter the bedizened world of our passions and our longings.

12 I returned two days later, having measured my apartment carefully.

13 My wife, Simo, was surprised to hear that all my practical arguments in favor of an upright—the cost, the size, the children—had vanished virtually overnight. "What happened to the idea of a small piano?"

14 I listed all my points in favor of a grand, babbling with enthusiasm as I recited the litany.

15 She listened silently, gave me a long look that mixed skepticism and understanding, then responded to my fervor with the practical point: "Well, we'd better figure out where your new baby is going to live."

16 Together we found a corner between the window and the bookcase that formed an acute angle where the Stingl could be wedged in our apartment's main room. We adjusted our budget for the price Luc quoted. It was a lot of money, particularly since I was just setting out on a new career path as a freelance writer, but my wife encouraged me to indulge my newfound sense of freedom: "Think of it as an investment in personal expression."

17 This time at the atelier² I did bring sheet music, and Luc nodded approvingly when he saw me set it on the music stand. I've never been comfortable playing in front of others, but somehow this was different; his presence seemed encouraging as we listened together to the particular voice of this instrument among so many other pianos. I played for perhaps ten minutes, pieces I knew reasonably well and could listen to while I sight-read: some Beethoven bagatelles, a few of Schumann's pieces for children, an early Mozart fantasy. I was not disappointed. The Stingl's resonance filled the room with

²An atelier is a workshop or studio of an artist.

tones at once clear and robust, and a sharp sense of pride welled up at the prospect of owning this distinctive piano, of seeing and playing it daily, of living with it. Good God, I thought, this is a kind of love; and, as in love, my senses amplified and enhanced the love object, all with an insouciance and willing enthusiasm.

18 I finished playing and turned to Luc with what must have been a delighted look on my face.

19 "I would say that you have found your piano." His eyes sparkled, the successful matchmaker rejoicing in his skill.

20 "And I would say that you were right."

Excerpt(s) from *The Piano Shop on the Left Bank: Discovering a Forgotten Passion in a Paris Atelier* by T. E. Carhart, copyright © 2000 by T. E. Carhart. Used by permission of Random House, an imprint and division of Penguin Random House LLC. All rights reserved.

Third party trademarks Stingl® and Steinway® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

from Those Old Piano Blues

by Neil Wertheimer
AARP Bulletin
October 2017

- 1 For much of the 20th century, most every self-respecting home in America had a piano. It was the home entertainment system long before the era of electronics; families would play and sing together, or listen to their children's recitals. The peak year for piano sales was 1909, when Americans bought 364,500 new models. Sales stayed high until the Depression and World War II years, but once the late '40s arrived, piano sales grew strong and steady again for the next 30 years.
- 2 Then a slow, downward sales arpeggio¹ started. In the late 1970s, "baby boomers began to stop buying new pianos," says Larry Fine, publisher of *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*. "Every year, a sales decline. People are doing other things." In 2016, sales of new acoustic pianos hit a low note of 30,000 units.
- 3 And as more families like ours downsize or move, used pianos have flooded the market. We discovered that no one wanted our Steinway — for any price, including free. We started with music stores that advertised "top dollar" for used pianos. After sending photos and details, we received only declines; one came with a form letter that rang with bitterness. "Pianos often have a substantial amount of emotional value to their owners, so it can be difficult to accept that many pianos do not have meaningful value on the open market," it told us. Reasons include a "tremendous oversupply" of pianos, less interest in them as a home furnishing, and the availability of "inexpensive, realistic" digital pianos.
- 4 The song had gone from major to minor, but we pressed on. None of our friends or relatives wanted it; neither did local churches, schools or charities. Then the song shifted to the saddest of blues. We discovered that the growth area in the business is paying someone to dispose of your old piano. "I've seen a boom in the last five years" of people getting rid of their pianos, says Bob Zahtilla at A Thru Z Piano, a company in Cleveland that sells and maintains, but also removes, pianos. He says he handles roughly five piano removals a month. "We tear them down, recycle the metals."
- 5 "We get lots of calls from schools and institutions looking to get rid of their pianos," adds Mike Ripatti at Beethoven Pianos in New York, another business that sells, services and disposes. They gather old pianos in their warehouse and, once they've accumulated a dozen or so, bring them to the dump. Disposal prices vary based on weight of the instrument and how treacherous its path to the truck is. Typical, though, is about \$300 for an upright.
- 6 But like many a blues song, this piano riff ends with hope. We finally did find a friend who wants our piano, so his young son can learn to play. And while the day of the home piano is passing, "there's no decline in piano lessons," says Natalia Huang, who has piano studios in New York, Los Angeles and Connecticut. "Younger students are brought in to promote a love of music and personal development," Huang says. "Adult students come in for personal growth and stress relief."
- 7 And to be sure, many older pianos have reached their coda.² "Sometimes, they're just ready," Zahtilla notes. A piano's life span is typically 50 years; at that point, it needs rebuilding if it is to be played as it was meant to. So the pruning of a century's worth of neglected home pianos might not be such a bad thing, if we continue to cherish the music.

Republished with permission of AARP Publications, from "Those Old Piano Blues: Once an American home staple, the instruments have fallen out of tune," Neil Wertheimer, 2017; permission conveyed through Copyright Clearance Center, Inc.
Third party trademarks *Acoustic & Digital Piano Buyer*®, *Steinway*®, *A Thru Z Piano*® and *Beethoven Pianos*® were used in these testing materials.

¹Arpeggios are the notes of a musical chord played quickly one after the other, either going up or down.

²Coda is an ending part of a piece of music that is separate from the earlier parts.

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q34 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 34 In the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> and the excerpt from the article “Those Old Piano Blues,” with which statement would both authors most likely agree? F Old pianos offer a great deal of emotional value to their owners. G Old pianos are constructed from better materials than new pianos. H People can learn a lot about the history of pianos from musicians. J People should learn to play on an acoustic piano before moving to a digital one.	Cluster	Literary Nonfiction	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F*	77	
	G	8	
	H	11	
	J	5	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (F)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q35 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 35 While the narrator of the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> finds an old Stingl valuable enough for him to spend a lot of money on it, the author of the excerpt from the article "Those Old Piano Blues" — A expects to sell an old Steinway for a high price B insists on donating his old piano to a school C gives an old Steinway to someone who wants it D thinks old pianos should be destroyed	Cluster	Literary Nonfiction	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	A	17	
	B	11	
	C*	67	
	D	6	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (C)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q36 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 36 What is one notable difference between the two excerpts? F The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> explains why someone wants to play piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” explains why piano lessons are less popular. G The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> describes evaluating and buying an old piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” describes an abundance of unwanted old pianos. H The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> emphasizes the craftsmanship of a new acoustic piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” emphasizes today’s preference for digital pianos. J The selection from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> shows how rare it is for someone to appreciate an old piano, while the selection from the article “Those Old Piano Blues” shows how people overvalue all musical instruments. 			

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q37 Passage #5A Literary NF and Passage #5B Informational 37 What feeling is conveyed by both the excerpt from <i>The Piano Shop on the Left Bank</i> and the excerpt from the article "Those Old Piano Blues"? A Amusement B Ambition C Attachment D Awe 			

Persuasive

E2.2 Vocabulary. The student uses newly acquired vocabulary expressively

E2.4 Comprehension. The student uses metacognitive skills to both develop and deepen comprehension of increasingly complex texts.

E2.5 Response Skills. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student responds to an increasingly challenging variety of sources that are read, heard, or viewed.

E2.7 Genres. The student recognizes and analyzes genre-specific characteristics, structures, and purposes within and across increasingly complex traditional, contemporary, classical, and diverse texts.

E2.8 Author's Purpose. listening, speaking, reading, writing, and thinking using multiple texts. The student uses critical inquiry to analyze the authors' choices and how they influence and communicate meaning within a variety of texts. The student analyzes and applies author's craft purposefully in order to develop his or her own products and performances.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Genre	Title	% Correct
2021	6	Persuasive	See Yourself Through the Eyes of Others	72

2021 Passage #6 – Persuasive (Questions 38-45)

72% Correct

from
See Yourself Through the Eyes of Others

by Jennifer Reynolds
 Chicago Review Press
 2013

1 Something happened to my exuberance as I approached high school. This deep desire of mine faded, as I was also influenced by a lack of self-worth. I felt as though I didn't have anything to say that was worthwhile. I was distracted by the voices and opinions of others.

2 One of my heroes, Mattie Stepanek, reminds me and everyone else about this truth in one of his poems entitled "Heart Song," from his book *Heartsongs*. Mattie was an inspirational 11-year-old child who suffered from a rare form of muscular dystrophy. He set his dreams high and showed the world the power involved in such an endeavor. He was a dreamer, a poet, and a peacemaker. This particular poem reminds us that there is hope, there is love, and there are dreams waiting to become realities deep within each of us. A few striking lines are:

I have a song, deep in my heart,
 And only I can hear it.
 If I close my eyes and sit very still
 It is so easy to listen to my song.

—Mattie J.T. Stepanek, *Heartsongs*

3 We often distract ourselves from these "heartsongs" in order to listen to louder, more obnoxious voices that taunt us from outside ourselves. They can lead us in directions we never should have ventured if we were honest with ourselves.

4 After I earned a master's degree in communications, my husband and I moved to Flagstaff, Arizona. We were immediately struck by the beauty of the San Francisco Peaks that are the pride of many who live there. Not too long after we settled in, we journeyed the hour and ten minutes to the Grand Canyon. The magnitude and grandeur of this natural wonder is spectacular.

5 During our visit we commented to each other how the colors, unlike the desert's browns and dull greens, were an elegant mix of reds, pinks, and yellows. The visible layers of the rock served as a metaphor for the life experiences we each held. In high school, I was standing on top of the rocks, but no incisions had been made—no canyon had been formed. There was a river and it was flowing, but I did not see the layers beneath. Throughout the years to the present

moment I am slowly allowing the river to cut through the rock of my past experiences. I have faith that in the end that process will reveal magnificent layers that inspire rather than repress and remain buried. It takes time to excavate a past, but it is well worth it.

6 After the fact, we can't change what has happened. You may not be able to change the voices you have believed any more than I can go back and rewrite my journal entries from high school. But these facts can become historical events; they can become past rather than present. And as you move beyond this pain, you can create extraordinary beauty.

7 If the Grand Canyon was made up of only one type of rock throughout the ages it would lack the stunning beauty it possesses today. What makes it awe inspiring and a destination for millions of people from all over the world is that a river cut through the rock for miles and miles and miles over many, many years to expose layers of color and texture. It is the history—a glimpse into the past—that is so phenomenal. There is a story that only the Grand Canyon can tell about the ages it has endured, the pain and cutting that has made it the beautiful site it is today.

8 You, too, have a story to tell about your experiences and how they have created the person you are today. It is the honesty that comes from examining, learning about, and sharing these layers as a whole that is inspirational.

9 During my life in high school, seeking approval from others was a deeply embedded pattern. It was toxic water to my spirit: I drank it in thinking it was life, but later came to find it was slowly killing me. Our fears, inhibitions, and need for approval from others are our cages. We become so used to hearing these voices and living under their rule that we give away hope of ever overcoming them. They transform into our security. And then we fool ourselves into thinking that our greatest fear is leaving these cages we have created for ourselves, our comfort zone: *What if I fail?* This is a lie that only serves to keep powerful people in captivity.

10 What could happen if you allowed yourself to step outside the cages and breathe in the fresh air of your freedom? How could you change the world—even the world of your high school—if you reclaimed your voice and pursued your dreams with reckless abandon? How might you inspire others to do the same, taking the power away from cynical doubters and dream stompers? It is worth fighting against the voices that seek to tell you that you can't, you shouldn't, or you aren't worth it.

11 I am learning to love and appreciate the woman who gazes back at me in the mirror every morning whispering a vote of confidence: *Don't be afraid of the power of your spirit, shine your light bright.* And the voices that taunted me in high school so many years ago? Their strength is hollow, and their message is powerless to touch the real me.

12 Start now by refusing to see yourself through the lens of others. Others do not define you. Their opinions will not last, and their words hold no power. You define you. And you don't need to fear your strength. It is as captivating as the Grand Canyon itself.

Used with permission.

E2.2(B) analyze context to distinguish among denotative, connotative, and figurative meanings of words	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q40 Passage #6 40 In paragraph 4, what does <i>grandeur</i> most nearly mean? F Elegance G Magnificence H Sophistication J Shapeliness	Cluster	Persuasive	
	Subcluster	Across Genres	
	Content	Readiness	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F	15	
	G*	74	
	H	6	
	J	5	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

*Correct Answer (G)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding

2021 – Q42 Passage #6

42 Read this quotation from paragraph 10.

What could happen if you allowed yourself to step outside the cages and breathe in the fresh air of your freedom?

Based on the quotation, the author views her high-school years as a source of —

F transition

G confinement

H order

J discipline

*Correct Answer (G)

Analysis of Assessed Standards

Cluster	Persuasive	
Subcluster	Across Genres	
Content	Readiness	
Process		
Stimulus		
Data Analysis		
Item	State	Local
F	21	
G*	65	
H	4	
J	10	

Error Analysis

☐ Guessing

☐ Mixed Up Concepts

☐ Careless Error

☐ Stopped Too Early

Learning from Mistakes
Instructional Implications

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q43 Passage #6	43 Based on paragraphs 4 and 5 of the selection, what can be inferred about the author?	Cluster	Persuasive	
		Subcluster	Across Genres	
		Content	Readiness	
		Process		
		Stimulus		
		Data Analysis		
		Item	State	Local
		A*	71	
		B	9	
	C	12		
	D	7		
		Error Analysis		
		☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts		
		☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
		Learning from Mistakes		
		Instructional Implications		

*Correct Answer (A)

E2.4(F) make inferences and use evidence to support understanding		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q44 Passage #6 44 According to the selection, the author urges high-school students to be — F concerned about their effects on others G opinionated and outspoken H unafraid of being themselves J willing to accept consequences for their actions	Cluster	Persuasive		
	Subcluster	Across Genres		
	Content	Readiness		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	F	8		
	G	11		
	H*	74		
	J	8		
	Error Analysis ☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

* Correct Answer (H)

E2.5(C) use text evidence and original commentary to support an interpretive response	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q38 Passage #6 38 Which sentence from the selection best expresses the author’s opinion about the culture of high school? F <i>Something happened to my exuberance as I approached high school. (paragraph 1)</i> G <i>It takes time to excavate a past, but it is well worth it. (paragraph 5)</i> H <i>You may not be able to change the voices you have believed any more than I can go back and rewrite my journal entries from high school. (paragraph 6)</i> J <i>It was toxic water to my spirit: I drank it in thinking it was life, but later came to find it was slowly killing me. (paragraph 9)</i> 			

E2.5(C) use text evidence and original commentary to support an interpretive response		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q45 Passage #6 45 Which sentence from paragraph 5 best illustrates the author’s feeling that her life experiences have made her more confident? A <i>During our visit we commented to each other how the colors, unlike the desert’s browns and dull greens, were an elegant mix of reds, pinks, and yellows.</i> B <i>In high school, I was standing on top of the rocks, but no incisions had been made—no canyon had been formed.</i> C <i>There was a river and it was flowing, but I did not see the layers beneath.</i> D <i>I have faith that in the end that process will reveal magnificent layers that inspire rather than repress and remain buried.</i>	Cluster	Persuasive		
	Subcluster	Across Genres		
	Content	Readiness		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A	9		
	B	14		
	C	6		
	D*	71		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts			
	☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

*Correct Answer (D)

E2.7(D) (i) [analyze characteristics and structural elements of informational texts such as] clear thesis, relevant supporting evidence, pertinent examples, and conclusion		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q39 Passage #6 39 In paragraph 2, what is the author’s main reason for including the anecdote about Mattie Stepanek? A Stepanek wrote poetry for high-school students. B Stepanek encouraged people to publish their writing. C Stepanek inspired others to overcome personal obstacles. D Stepanek helped others deal with physical challenges.	Cluster	Persuasive		
	Subcluster			
	Content	Readiness		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A	4		
	B	6		
	C*	81		
	D	9		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

* Correct Answer (C)

E2.7(D) (i) [analyze characteristics and structural elements of informational texts such as] clear thesis, relevant supporting evidence, pertinent examples, and conclusion		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q41 Passage #6 41 What evidence does the author primarily use to support her message? A Quotations from well-known individuals B Comparisons to other high-school students C Reflections on personal experiences D Causes that led her to move to a new location	Cluster	Persuasive		
	Subcluster			
	Content	Readiness		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A	8		
	B	8		
	C*	80		
	D	4		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

* Correct Answer (C)

Extended Constructed Response (Composition)

E2.9 Writing Process. The student uses the writing process recursively to compose multiple texts that are legible and uses appropriate conventions.

E2.10 Genres. The student uses genre characteristics and craft to compose multiple texts that are meaningful.

No Passage

E2.9(B) (i) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] using an organizing structure appropriate to purpose, audience, topic, and context

E2.9(B) (ii) developing an engaging idea reflecting depth of thought with specific details, examples, and commentary

E2.9(C) revise drafts to improve clarity, development, organization, style, diction, and sentence effectiveness, including use of parallel constructions and placement of phrases and dependent clauses

OLD E2.16(A) a clear thesis or position based on logical reasons supported by precise and relevant evidence

Analysis of Assessed Standards

2021 – Q Passage #None

WRITTEN COMPOSITION: Persuasive

Read the following quotation.

Don't spend so much time chasing your future that you run over your present.

—Carlos Wallace

Some people focus so much on the future that they do not enjoy the present. Others spend so much time living in the present that they do not prepare for the future. Carefully consider this statement.

Write an essay stating your opinion on which is more important: preparing for the future or focusing on the present.

Be sure to —

- state your position clearly
- use appropriate organization
- provide specific support for your argument
- choose your words carefully
- edit your writing for grammar, mechanics, and spelling

*Correct Answer (A scoring guide is used to determine the score for the written composition.)

Cluster	Extended Constructed Response (Composition)
Subcluster	
Content	Readiness
Process	
Stimulus	

Data Analysis

Item	State	Local

Error Analysis

- ☐ Guessing
 ☐ Mixed Up Concepts
☐ Careless Error
 ☐ Stopped Too Early

Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications

Revision

E2.9 Writing Process. Students use elements of the writing process (planning, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing) to compose text.

E2.10 Genres. The student uses genre characteristics and craft to compose multiple texts that are meaningful.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Revision	Title
2021	1	Revision	Four Days Is Enough
2021	2	Revision	A New Discovery about the Brain

2021 Passage #1 – Writing (Questions 1-4)

Nancy wrote this essay to promote an idea she believes would improve the lives of students. Read Nancy's essay and look for the revisions she should make. When you finish reading, answer the questions that follow.

Four Days Is Enough

(1) Students, are you having a difficult time completing all the activities in your schedule? (2) Teachers, are you exhausted from nonstop work? (3) You are not alone. (4) Every day in schools across the nation, teens have challenging classes, hours of homework, and extracurricular activities such as sports and music.

(5) By Friday, students are waking up exhausted, but they must drag themselves through one more school day. (6) Likewise, teachers are spending their weekends grading papers and preparing lessons instead of relaxing with family and friends.

(7) In this program students spend a little more time in school four days a week. (8) Then they have Friday off to catch up on their sleep, enjoy time with family and friends, and complete their many responsibilities. (9) Although some experts fear that reducing the length of the school week will worsen student learning, recent studies contradict this. (10) In 2015 Dr. Mark Anderson of Montana State University and Dr. Mary Beth Walker of Georgia State University reviewed scores for Colorado elementary school students who were placed in a four-day system.

(11) They found that math scores improved by about 7 percent, and reading scores also improved. (12) "We thought that especially for the younger elementary school kids, longer days on a shorter school week would hurt their academic performance because their attention spans are shorter," Dr. Walker said. (13) Researchers also thought a longer weekend would give students more of an opportunity to forget what they had learned. (14) Clearly this was not the case. (15) The study cited shows this hypothesis is incorrect.

(16) Teachers are also noticing other benefits from shorter school weeks.

(17) Shana Myers teaches in a four-day program near Phoenix, Arizona. (18) Myers says that the "Friday slump," when students would seem tired through the day, is

gone. (19) Absences are also down, as parents can schedule appointments for kids on Fridays. (20) They are also paying more attention when in school. (21) They are alert, they answer questions, and they are interested in what they are learning.

(22) Myers thinks the changes in students' behavior are partly due to the improved lessons that she and the other teachers are able to create. (23) While some educators and parents may argue that teachers cannot prepare effective lessons in a shorter school week, many teachers offer an alternative scenario. (24) Before, they had to work on weekends to plan lessons. (25) Now, they are using Friday as their planning day. (26) "We're still in school mode on Fridays, and we've found we're creating far superior lessons," Myers says. (27) High school English teacher Candyce Matlosz has found that longer days allow students to spend more time on activities. (28) And as a teacher with over twenty years of experience, Matlosz knows a lot about teaching English. (29) "For example, the science teachers have enough time to run labs, have the students write the lab reports, and clean up the labs in one class period," she says. (30) "In English class, students can write a rough draft, revise, and write a final draft of essays in one or two days instead of taking a week."

(31) School budgets may benefit from a shortened week as well.

(32) Introducing the four-day school week may provide a way for school districts to save money in areas where budgets are strained. (33) School budgets are stretched. (34) Districts reduce spending on fuel, bus drivers' salaries, and maintenance when they decrease the number of days students are transported to and from school. (35) Expenses to keep facilities open and clean are also lowered, as are food costs.

(36) The evidence in favor of switching to four-day school weeks is overwhelming. (37) Clearly it's time for our school system to implement this innovative program in our area. (38) For teachers, schools, and students, it is a winning solution.

E2.9(B) (i) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] using an organizing structure appropriate to purpose, audience, topic, and context		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q2 Passage #1 2 Which of these sentences should Nancy add at the beginning of the second paragraph (sentences 7–15) to serve as the most effective position statement for her essay? F I think I would like the four-day school week because I would enjoy the extra time to rest on the weekend. G The four-day school week is a great idea for all students and parents, and even the school district would likely benefit. H We spend way too much time during the week in school, and it would be nice to have a three-day weekend for a part-time job or to just relax. J The four-day school week provides benefits that would help the students, teachers, and schools in our district. * Correct Answer (J)		Cluster	Revision	
		Subcluster		
		Content	Readiness	
		Process		
		Stimulus		
		Data Analysis		
		Item	State	Local
		F	3	
		G	20	
		H	11	
		J*	66	
		Error Analysis		
		☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts		
		☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

E2.9(B) (ii) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] developing an engaging idea reflecting depth of thought with specific details, examples, and commentary	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q3 Passage #1 3 Which sentence in the fourth paragraph (sentences 22–30) is extraneous and should be deleted? A Sentence 27 B Sentence 28 C Sentence 29 D Sentence 30 			

E2.9(B) (ii) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] developing an engaging idea reflecting depth of thought with specific details, examples, and commentary		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q4 Passage #1 4 Nancy is concerned that she has included a redundant sentence in the fifth paragraph (sentences 31–35). Which sentence should be deleted from the paragraph? F Sentence 32 G Sentence 33 H Sentence 34 J Sentence 35 <				

E2.9(C) revise drafts to improve clarity, development, organization, style, diction, and sentence effectiveness, including use of parallel constructions and placement of phrases and dependent clauses	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q1 Passage #1 1 Nancy has not used the most effective word in sentence 4. Which word should replace <i>have</i> to create a more effective sentence? A carry B accept C manage D enroll <			

2021 Passage #2 – Writing (Questions 5-9)

Reese wrote this essay for his biology class. Read Reese's essay and look for any revisions he needs to make. When you finish reading, answer the questions that follow.

A New Discovery about the Brain

(1) But there is still one part of the human body that confuses scientists: the brain. (2) Although scientists have made extraordinary progress in understanding how the brain functions, there still is much to learn. (3) In fact, scientists are only now beginning to discover and understand the lymphatic system of the brain.

(4) The lymphatic system performs an important role in the overall functioning of the body, much like the circulatory system. (5) The lymphatic system also moves things around the body. (6) Instead of bringing the body what it needs through the blood, however, the lymphatic system carries away what the body doesn't need, such as germs and waste products, through a fluid called "lymph."

(7) The lymph then travels to the various lymph nodes throughout the body. (8) As the lymph is filtered through the lymph nodes, the nodes respond to any germs by mounting an appropriate defense.

(9) Scientists have been stumped by this process. (10) But in 2012 scientists found that the brain has its own type of lymphatic system. (11) Dr. Maiken Nedergaard and her team of researchers were surprised and excited to discover the first evidence of a tightly interwoven system that rapidly removes waste from the brain. (12) The brain's blood vessels have fluid that is running along the side of them, the team determined, and this fluid is what is carrying waste away from the brain. (13) However, unlike the lymphatic system—which operates on a slow, continuous basis—this newly discovered system operates only when a person is asleep, washing away waste by flooding the brain quickly with fluid. (14) Now you have one more reason to get a good night's sleep.

(15) It took three more years for scientists to discover the specific vessels in the brain that are part of this lymphatic system. (16) In 2015, researchers were able to provide proof of a lymphatic system in the brain when they actually managed to see the vessels that are used to flood the brain and carry away the waste. (17) Even though what this relatively new discovery means is still not entirely clear, researchers are already making connections. (18) For example, many brain diseases, including Alzheimer's disease, involve the accumulation of specific proteins in the brain. (19) Although it is too early to jump to conclusions, it is reasonable to infer that these diseases may be connected in some way to the ability of this newly discovered lymphatic system to remove waste from the brain. (20) In the future, scientists will attempt to prove this connection.

(21) The discovery of an entirely new system opens up exciting new areas of research and inquiry. (22) It may offer more opportunities for discoveries as researchers increase their understanding of how this system functions and how it is related to health and disease. (23) Eventually, we may gain a fuller understanding of the mysterious workings of the human brain.

E2.9(B) (i) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] using an organizing structure appropriate to purpose, audience, topic, and context		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q5 Passage #2 5 Reese needs to improve the introduction of his essay. Which sentence should be added before sentence 1 to create a more effective introduction for his essay? A There are so many mysteries about the human body that you would never believe it. B The brain is like the body’s big jigsaw puzzle. C Over the past centuries, many of the mysteries of the human body have been explained by science. D Scientists are determined to find out all the facts that can help them understand our world. 				

E2.9(B) (i) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] using an organizing structure appropriate to purpose, audience, topic, and context		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q6 Passage #2 6 Reese is considering adding this idea to his second paragraph (sentences 4–8). <i>The circulatory system moves blood rich with nutrients and oxygen to all the different parts of the body.</i> Where should Reese insert this idea? F After sentence 4 G After sentence 5 H After sentence 6 J Reese should not insert this idea. 				

E2.9(B) (i) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] using an organizing structure appropriate to purpose, audience, topic, and context		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q7 Passage #2 7 Reese needs a better transition between the second paragraph (sentences 4–8) and the third paragraph (sentences 9–14). Which sentence should replace sentence 9 to create a more effective transition? A Until recently, scientists could not determine how the brain is able to rid itself of waste because the lymphatic system does not include the brain. B Scientists researched the brain for years before finally making a breakthrough. C No one knew how the brain was able to perform some functions. D The lymphatic system does not include the brain, so everyone always wondered about that. * Correct Answer (A)		Cluster	Revision	
		Subcluster		
		Content	Readiness	
		Process		
		Stimulus		
		Data Analysis		
		Item	State	Local
		A*	67	
		B	12	
		C	13	
		D	8	
		Error Analysis		
		☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

E2.9(B) (ii) [develop drafts into a focused, structured, and coherent piece of writing in timed and open-ended situations by] developing an engaging idea reflecting depth of thought with specific details, examples, and commentary		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q9 Passage #2 9 Which sentence should Reese add after sentence 18 to provide additional support for the inference in sentence 19? A It would be a good idea to get rid of these bad proteins. B Another type of protein is important to building strong muscles. C Alzheimer’s is a disease that is heavily researched. D Some of these same proteins appear in the waste products of brain cells. * Correct Answer (D)		Cluster	Revision	
		Subcluster		
		Content	Readiness	
		Process		
		Stimulus		
		Data Analysis		
		Item	State	Local
		A	12	
		B	5	
		C	8	
		D*	75	
		Error Analysis		
		☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications				

Editing

E2.9 Writing Process. Students use elements of the writing process (planning, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing) to compose text.

E2.10 Genres. The student uses genre characteristics and craft to compose multiple texts that are meaningful.

To view passages, click on the title

Year	Passage #	Editing	Title
2021	3	Editing	Sally Ride - The Woman Who Broke the Space Ceiling
2021	4	Editing	The United States Needs the Metric System

2021 Passage #3 – Writing (Questions 10-14)

Yesenia wrote this essay about an important figure she admires. Read Yesenia's essay and look for any corrections she needs to make. When you finish reading, answer the questions that follow.

Sally Ride — The Woman Who Broke the Space Ceiling

(1) Before Sally Ride joined NASA in the 1970s, the idea of a woman becoming an astronaut seemed incomprehensible. (2) Ride was intrigued by the space program, but she did not necessarily envision becoming an astronaut. (3) Additionally, she had little interest in being famous as a symbol of feminism or as a trailblazer. (4) In 1983, however, she became both a symbol of feminism and a trailblazer as the United States' first female astronaut in space. (5) Her expertise in science, her dedication, and her hard work allowed Ride to break barriers and create opportunities for future scientists.

(6) Ride developed a love for science early. (7) Her parents encouraged this love by giving her a telescope and a chemistry set as a child. (8) After high school she continued studying science in college and earned both a bachelor's and a master's degree in physics and a Ph.D. in astrophysics.

(9) While Ride was working on her Ph.D., the trajectory of her career changed. (10) Traditionally NASA had focused on recruiting only male military pilots for the astronaut program. (11) However, in 1977 NASA began a campaign to recruit both female scientists and female pilots. (12) Ride saw one of the campaigns advertisements and realized that she met the qualifications, so she applied.

(13) Ride was accepted into the astronaut program and began preparing for a space mission. (14) Trained both physically and mentally. (15) She also shifted her focus from physics to engineering so that she could help develop a robotic arm for the space shuttle. (16) The expertise she demonstrated in designing and operating the robotic arm earned Ride a spot on the space shuttle *Challenger* during its 1983 mission. (17) When the shuttle broke free of Earth's atmosphere Ride broke through the country's highest glass ceiling by becoming the first American woman to fly in space. (18) She was an instant celebrity.

(19) While Ride loved her work at NASA, she did not enjoy all the publicity that resulted from her accomplishments. (20) As a deeply private person, Ride had no desire to be on the covers of magazines or to do product endorsements. (21) In fact, all she wanted to do was fly in space. (22) She explained this after the first of her two space missions by saying, "I am sure it was the most fun that I'll ever have in my life." (23) Perhaps only her passion for science could rival her passion for spaceflight.

(24) After retiring from NASA, Ride becomes a fierce advocate for science education. (25) Focusing on the middle grades and on female students in particular, she wrote books, gave talks, and started programs to promote her cause. (26) Her new goal became helping others to discover their own love of science and the world of opportunity a strong science background can open.

(27) Sally Ride did not set out to be an astronaut or a hero; nevertheless, she became both. (28) While flying was her joy, science education was her mission. (29) Cofounded by Ride and others, Sally Ride Science is a foundation that promotes science and technology education among young people. (30) Its programs provide students with opportunities to make breakthroughs in new fields of science and encourage them to shatter glass ceilings in all fields.

Third party trademarks NASA® and Sally Ride Science® were used in these testing materials.

E2.9(D) (i) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] a variety of complete, controlled sentences and avoidance of unintentional splices, run-ons, and fragments		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q12 Passage #3 12 What is the correct way to write sentences 13 and 14? F Ride was accepted into the astronaut program and began preparing for a space mission; trained both physically and mentally. G Ride was accepted into the astronaut program and began preparing for a space mission by training both physically and mentally. H Ride was accepted into the astronaut program and began preparing for a space mission: trained both physically and mentally. J Ride was accepted into the astronaut program and began preparing for a space mission and she training both physically and mentally. <				

E2.9(D) (ii) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] consistent, appropriate use of verb tense and active and passive voice		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q14 Passage #3 14 What change, if any, is needed in sentence 24? F Change <i>becomes</i> to <i>became</i> G Change <i>fierce</i> to <i>feirce</i> H Change <i>advocate</i> to <i>advocates</i> J No change is needed in sentence 24. 				

E2.9(D) (v) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] punctuation, including commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, and parentheses to set off phrases and clauses as appropriate		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q11 Passage #3 11 What change is needed in sentence 12? A Change <i>campaigns</i> to campaign’s B Change <i>advertisements</i> to advertizements C Change <i>realized</i> to realizing D Delete the comma after <i>qualifications</i>	Cluster	Editing		
	Subcluster			
	Content	Supporting		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A*	71		
	B	5		
	C	8		
	D	16		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

* Correct Answer (A)

E2.9(D) (v) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] punctuation, including commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, and parentheses to set off phrases and clauses as appropriate		Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q13 Passage #3 13 What change is needed in sentence 17? A Change <i>broke free</i> to <i>breaks free</i> B Insert a comma after <i>atmosphere</i> C Change <i>country’s</i> to <i>countries</i> D Insert a comma after <i>ceiling</i>	Cluster	Editing		
	Subcluster			
	Content	Supporting		
	Process			
	Stimulus			
	Data Analysis			
	Item	State	Local	
	A	5		
	B*	65		
	C	20		
	D	9		
	Error Analysis			
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts			
	☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early			
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications			

* Correct Answer (B)

E2.9(D) (vi) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] correct spelling

2021 – Q10 Passage #3

10

What change is needed in sentence 1?

F

Insert a comma after **NASA**

G

Change *idea* to *ideas*

H

Change *becoming* to *to become*

J

Change *incomprehensible* to *incomprehensable*

Analysis of Assessed Standards

Cluster

Editing

Subcluster

Content

Supporting

Process

Stimulus

Data Analysis

Item

State

Local

F

11

G

4

H

8

J*

77

Error Analysis

☐ Guessing

☐ Mixed Up Concepts

☐ Careless Error

☐ Stopped Too Early

Learning from Mistakes

Instructional Implications

*Correct Answer (J)

2021 Passage #4 – Writing (Questions 15-18)

Saul wrote this essay to persuade readers of the importance of switching to the metric system. Read Saul's essay and look for the corrections he needs to make. Then answer the questions that follow.

The United States Needs the Metric System

(1) Since the mid-1800s the United States has been struggling with the question of whether or not to adopt the metric system. (2) The country was one of seventeen nations that signed the 1875 Treaty of the Metre, which increased the accuracy of the metric system and established the International Bureau of weights and measures. (3) However, despite this early involvement, the United States has been reluctant to adopt the metric system as its only standard of measurement.

(4) The United States is the only industrialized country that does not use metric as its dominant system. (5) As a general rule, people are not comfortable with change; this may be the reason that many cling to the old measurement system of miles, feet, inches, and pounds. (6) Yet changes in trade and technology have made using metric measurements more important than ever. (7) For example, the metric system makes writing very large and small numbers easier. (8) If the country is to thrive in international competition, it must adopt the metric system as its official measurement system.

(9) This adoption would not be a dramatic change in some areas. (10) For example, U.S. scientists use the metric system exclusively; because it provides a standard that is understood worldwide. (11) Because scientific research is often international in nature, a common measurement system must be used to avoid error and facilitate communication.

(12) In medicine, safety experts are urging all medical providers to use only the metric system. (13) Errors occurring because of confusion between the two measurement systems are among the top ten safety concerns for hospitals. (14) Drug dosages are often based on a patient's weight, so confusing pounds and

kilograms can have serious consequences. (15) Imagine trying to convert pounds to kilograms in a hurry! (16) One safety analyst remarked that using pounds in drug calculations is like functioning in the Stone Age.

(17) Many U.S. manufacturers have had positive experiences in changing to metric. (18) For instance, Procter & Gamble created a metric diaper manufacturing machine and found that it cost less than previous machines, was able to function 25 percent faster, and was easier to repair and maintain. (19) Another example is Caterpillar, Inc., which decided to go metric in the United States in order to avoid problems with measurement conversion for its plants in other countries. (20) The company found that being consistently metric made its products more popular worldwide and reduced production costs.

(21) Those hesitant about the switch might complain that instead of the familiar miles, feet, and ounces, the metric system uses different units, a meter measures length, a gram measures mass, and a liter measures volume. (22) The metric system is easy to learn, however, because everything is measured in multiples of ten. (23) For example, a kilo equals 1,000, and thus 1,000 meters is called 1 kilometer. (24) If children were taught these simple calculations when they begin to study math, they would learn how easy the metric system is to use.

(25) Although change takes time, the conversion to the metric system will be worth it in the long run. (26) While "thinking in metric" won't happen instantaneously, the simplicity of the metric system will make the transition easier. (27) Once the United States has made the change, its citizens will become accustomed to the metric system, just as they have become familiar with using new technologies, such as computers, cell phones, and the internet. (28) Best of all, they will be using the same system as 95 percent of the world, in turn it will contribute to safety, facilitate trade, and improve international communication.

Third party trademarks Procter & Gamble® and Caterpillar, Inc.® were used in these testing materials.

E2.9(D) (i) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] a variety of complete, controlled sentences and avoidance of unintentional splices, run-ons, and fragments	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q18 Passage #4 18 What is the correct way to write sentence 28? F Best of all, they will be using the same system as 95 percent of the rest of the world, in turn this will contribute to safety, facilitate trade, and improve international communication. G Best of all, they will be using the same system as 95 percent of the rest of the world; in turn contributes to safety, facilitate trade, and improve international communication. H Best of all, they will be using the same system as 95 percent of the rest of the world, which in turn will contribute to safety, facilitate trade, and improve international communication. J Best of all, they will be using the same system as 95 percent of the rest of the world. In turn will contribute to safety, facilitate trade, and improve international communication. 			

E2.9(D) (iv) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] correct capitalization

2021 – Q15 Passage #4

15 What change should be made in sentence 2?

A Change *signed* to *signs*

B Change *Metre* to *metre*

C Change *which* to *this*

D Change *weights and measures* to *Weights and Measures*

Analysis of Assessed Standards

Cluster

Editing

Subcluster

Content

Supporting

Process

Stimulus

Data Analysis

Item

State

Local

A

2

B

6

C

25

D*

66

Error Analysis

☐ Guessing

☐ Mixed Up Concepts

☐ Careless Error

☐ Stopped Too Early

Learning from Mistakes

Instructional Implications

*Correct Answer (D)

E2.9(D) (v) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] punctuation, including commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, and parentheses to set off phrases and clauses as appropriate	Analysis of Assessed Standards		
2021 – Q16 Passage #4 16 What change, if any, should be made in sentence 10? F Change <i>use</i> to <i>using</i> G Delete the semicolon H Insert a comma after <i>standard</i> J No change is needed. *Correct Answer (G)	Cluster	Editing	
	Subcluster		
	Content	Supporting	
	Process		
	Stimulus		
	Data Analysis		
	Item	State	Local
	F	5	
	G*	65	
	H	6	
	J	24	
	Error Analysis		
	☐ Guessing ☐ Mixed Up Concepts ☐ Careless Error ☐ Stopped Too Early		
	Learning from Mistakes Instructional Implications		

E2.9(D) (v) [edit drafts using standard English conventions, including] punctuation, including commas, semicolons, colons, dashes, and parentheses to set off phrases and clauses as appropriate

2021 – Q17 Passage #4

17 What change, if any, should be made in sentence 21?

A Delete the comma after ounces

B Change uses to used

C Change the comma after units to a colon

D Make no change

Analysis of Assessed Standards

ClusterEditing

Subcluster

ContentSupporting

Process

Stimulus

Data Analysis

ItemStateLocal

A23

B10

C*47

D20

Error Analysis

☐ Guessing☐ Mixed Up Concepts

☐ Careless Error☐ Stopped Too Early

Learning from Mistakes

Instructional Implications

* Correct Answer (C)

* Correct Answer ()